along with him and assisted in setting up the bank by joining as Superintendent of the Current Accounts and Bills department. Deepak Parekh, H.T. Parekh's nephew and the Chairman of HDFC, recalls how his grandfather put up the *toran* on the door of the new branch. A.S. Balsekar, another colleague from the Bank of India joined as Chief Accountant.[9]

Buoyed by the success in gathering subscriptions, they arranged to register the bank on December 21, 1911. The Central Bank soon secured the confidence of the public: Sorabji's faith in himself and his fellow countrymen stood vindicated. Given the winds of swadeshi sweeping the country, it is not surprising that the trio got the idea of approaching Sir Pherozeshah Mehta, noted for his integrity and staunch nationalism, to be the Chairman of the bank. Vicaji's acquaintance with Lady Mehta greatly smoothed matters in this regard and Sir Pherozeshah agreed to meet Vicaji and Sorabji. When the offer was made, Sir Pherozeshah told Sorabji that he had declined a similar offer from the Credit Bank of India as he had found some of the clauses in the Articles of Association unacceptable. Sorabji assured him that he was willing to make any changes Sir Pherozeshah wished and the latter promised to think over his proposal.

After an anxious wait, Sorabji got his reply. Sir Pherozeshah was willing to be the Chairman provided the Articles of Association were changed to place the entire responsibility for management on the Board of Directors. Sorabji readily agreed and at the meeting of Directors on December 28, 1911, the relevant Article was amended and a formal invitation was extended to Sir Pherozeshah to join the Board as the Chairman. Nanporia notes that Sir Pherozeshah 'responded to the pioneering spirit in Sorabji, sensing in him an amalgam of ideals and ability and determination.'[10] Sir Pherozeshah took the chair at a Board meeting on January 24, 1912, and the Articles were finally changed at the statutory meeting held on June 19, 1912. The share list closed on March 15, 1912, and the capital of ₹20 lakhs was fully subscribed. Within a week more than seventy current accounts totaling ₹1.5 lakhs were opened. A.F. Ferguson & Co. and Batliboi & Batliboi were named as the auditors and Ardesir Hormusjee Dinshaw & Co. as the solicitors.

Why did Sorabji accept an arrangement where he was relegated to a secondary position with regard to the Board? The obvious answer is that he was anxious to get the Central Bank off the ground. Also, he must have